

Linux Command Cheat Sheet

THE CORE COMMANDS

Works on Void, Arch, and XUbuntu. Deleting has no undo, so read `rm` lines twice.

Getting around

`pwd` Print the directory you are in

`ls` List files in this directory

`ls -l` Long listing with details

`ls -a` Include hidden dotfiles

`ls -lh` Long listing, readable sizes

`cd DIR` Change into a directory

`cd ..` Go up one level

`cd` Go to your home directory

`cd -` Return to the previous directory

Files and directories

`mkdir DIR` Make a new directory

`touch FILE` Create an empty file

`cp A B` Copy file A to B

`cp -r A B` Copy a directory and its contents

`mv A B` Move or rename

`rm FILE` Delete a file (no undo)

`rm -r DIR` Delete a directory (be careful)

`rmdir DIR` Delete an empty directory

Viewing and editing

`cat FILE` Print a whole file

`less FILE` Scrollable view; press `q` to quit

`head FILE` Show the first lines

`tail FILE` Show the last lines

`wc -l FILE` Count the lines in a file

`nano FILE` Edit a file

In nano: `Ctrl+O` then Enter saves, `Ctrl+X` exits.

Redirection and pipes

`CMD > FILE` Send output into a file, replacing it

`CMD >> FILE` Add output to the end of a file

`CMD1 | CMD2` Feed one command into the next

`grep WORD FILE` Keep only lines that match a word

Getting help

`man CMD` Full manual; press `q` to quit

`CMD --help` Short summary in the terminal

`apropos WORD` Find commands related to a word

`tldr CMD` Common examples, when installed

Permissions

`ls -l` View permissions at the start of each line

`chmod +x FILE` Allow a file to run as a program

Reading `-rwxr-xr--`: the first mark is the type, then three each for owner, group, and everyone else (read, write, execute).

Installing software

Same idea everywhere; only the tool changes.

`sudo apt install NAME` XUbuntu: add a program

`sudo apt update` XUbuntu: refresh and upgrade

`sudo pacman -S NAME` Arch: add a program

`sudo pacman -Syu` Arch: refresh and upgrade

`sudo xbps-install NAME` Void: add a program

`sudo xbps-install -Su` Void: refresh and upgrade

`sudo` runs a command with administrator power. Use it only when needed.

Handy shortcuts

`Tab` Auto-complete a file or command name

`Up arrow` Bring back the previous command

`Ctrl+C` Cancel the running command

`clear` Wipe the screen and start fresh

`history` List the commands you have run

`exit` Close the terminal